Peabody

THAMESMEAD TM

# Thamesmead Newsletter
August 2020

# Getting back to "normal"



We know this is still a testing and trying time for everyone but thankfully some of the things we took for granted before lockdown are now returning to give some sense of normality.

For instance, we've been working with shop owners in the **town centre**, putting in place measures such as signage and floor markings, so you can shop safely.

Our outdoor spaces continue to be so important as somewhere people can exercise, relax and refresh. We've carried on improving these over recent weeks with an eye-catching fountain now installed at **Southmere Lake**.

And while we've sadly had to postpone this year's **Festival** there'll still be an opportunity to celebrate the best the town has to offer with the **Thamesmead Market** at **Southmere Lake** on Sunday 9 August – while respecting social distancing of course.

Elsewhere, **The Moorings underpass** (pictured) has been completely renovated with new lighting and an amazing colourful mural, co-designed with the young people of **Woolwich Polytechnic** and **Hawksmoor Youth Club**.

I'm also delighted to say that hundreds of you enthusiastically signed up for the **Making Space for Nature** summer salad kits and are growing your own food at home.

If you think you might need some extra support at this time you'll find who to contact for help and advice at both **Peabody**, as well as our partners at **Royal Borough of Greenwich** and **London Borough of Bexley**, on page six of this newsletter.

Stay safe and well.

**John Lewis,**
Thamesmead Executive Director, Peabody

## Spout and about

The most eye-catching addition to the work at **Southmere Lake** is the creation of a new fountain. It can be set to light up in a range of colours and is being tested at the moment.

Along with the new seating, reed beds and fishing platforms we've recently installed, the new water feature is another way of making the lake a really pleasant place to relax.

Next to the lake, **Southmere Village** is continuing with internal fittings such as kitchens going in the first phase of blocks and brick exteriors nearly complete. The outside of the library is now finished, and we're starting on the internal work.



image credit: Paul Elliot @respectedphotographylondon

On **Claridge Way** the growing club area now has a potting shed and more garden fencing is going up.

While **Crossway Park** is starting to reveal its blooming secret – hundreds of sunflowers which the Peabody Estate Services team planted earlier this year to help brighten up the area.




# Town centre open for business again

**Peabody** has been working with shop owners in the **town centre** to help them open within government guidelines after they had to shut their doors during lockdown.

Most have now re-opened and to make sure everyone stays safe we've installed signs and floor markings in the car park and common areas, so please respect them when you're out shopping.

The stores in the centre rely on local people to stay in business so please support them and buy local. Remember to wear a facemask to help protect you and your fellow shoppers. It's being vigilant that will help to keep shops open.

## Archive website coming soon

Peabody's Culture team is working with local design team Dos Studio, designer Peter Chadwick and TACO to create a website for the Thamesmead Community Archive.

The Thamesmead Archive is funded by the National Lottery Heritage Fund and has been collecting residents' photos, maps, papers and memories since 2018.

All that fascinating material is now being added to a website so everyone can see and access it. It's due to be launched later this summer so visit www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk for more details.




## Thamesmead Festival to bounce back

Unfortunately, because of the Coronavirus pandemic, we have had to postpone the 2020 **Thamesmead Festival** until 2021.

The event is produced by the Thamesmead Festival Production Group, made up of 11 dedicated residents, who work collaboratively with Peabody's Thamesmead cultural team as well as producers, Serious.

**Julia Hien**, a resident on the Production Group said: "While it's sad the festival can no longer go ahead this year it has encouraged us to continue to work hard at ensuring community spirit is very much alive at next year's event, from the planning stages to the day itself!"

For the latest updates on the Thamesmead Festival 2021, visit www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk and our social media outlets.



## THAMESMEAD SESSIONS 2.0



Interested in developing personal skills, learning about growth sectors or achieving goals, there's a **Thamesmead Session** for that

"What I learned and benefited from the sessions is to come up with a vision that gets me going every day"
Enoch

| | |
|---|---|
| **11 August** | How to transform your business idea into reality |
| **25 August** | Learn about Construction |
| **08 September** | Landscaping your future – Green Skills |
| **22 September** | Digital inclusion: Skills for work and life |
| **06 October** | How to kick start your career in Gaming |
| **20 October** | Explore the Creative Industries |
| **03 November** | Understanding the Fashion Industry |
| **07 November** | An introduction into Social media for businesses and influencers |
| **01 December** | Young People Services |

**Sessions delivered via zoom**
**11am - 12:30pm**

Book your place with
**thamesmead.portal@peabody.org.uk**
**or call 07880101223**

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# Back to school Sarah finds job



Thamesmead resident **Sarah Blyth** was finding it difficult to get back into job market once her two children, who she'd raised as a lone parent, left school.

After months of disappointment due to her lack of qualifications, one of Sarah's neighbours suggested she try **The Link** and speak to a Peabody work adviser.

Adviser **Ian Diggens** helped with writing CV and cover letters, completing online application forms, personal statements, interview preparation and careers guidance, but Sarah still didn't have any luck getting responses.

Ian then told her about a new NVQ Level 2 Teaching Assistant course, which lasted three months and included a two days-a-week school placement. Sarah passed the course and enjoyed it so much she then signed up for a Level 3 Diploma in Learning and Support Assistant qualification.

After completing both courses, she applied for jobs in local primary schools and to her delight got a job as a Learning and Support Assistant with her first application.

**Sarah** said: "Peabody was extremely supportive and even provided childcare for each parent. Once I completed the courses, I felt a sense of self-worth and extremely proud of myself and all that I'd achieved.

"Now that I am employed, I am living a comfortable life with a regular income, I now no longer receive benefits so I'm not reliant on Job Seeker Allowance. I felt that I had a purpose in society again."

If you're interested in exploring training opportunities like Sarah contact employment.training@peabody.org.uk



# Summer salad kit success

**Making Space for Nature's Summer Salad Kits** have been a great success with all 300 of them being snapped up by local residents in just a few days.

The programme has been so popular that **Making Space for Nature** will be giving away more growing kits in the Autumn with herbs and seasonal vegetables on the menu.

To make sure you get one of the kits check www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk where you can also join the Making Space for Nature mailing list.







# Lockdown masterclass

Young people in Thamesmead have been improving their skills during lockdown thanks to a series of masterclasses.

Ten local youngsters have been taking part in online **Masterclass Tuesdays** via Zoom, organised by Peabody's Youth Development Coordinator, Nadia Kassab, after consultation with those currently taking part in programmes.

Over seven weeks, 18 Masterclasses have helped them to develop their business and negotiation skills in areas including: Tactical Empathy; Mirroring; Body Language and Bargaining.

Participant, **Julia Huynh**, 18, said: "In this time of uncertainty, having Masterclass Tuesdays has prompted me to follow a schedule and refine my time management and self-discipline skills."

Masterclasses covering a variety of different areas will continue to run throughout the year. Anyone interested in taking part should contact Nadia at nadia.kassab@peabody.org.uk

# Making Space for Nature

# Summer Checklist!

**25** Free things to do when exploring Thamesmead's parks and open spaces this summer holiday.

**No equipment needed!**



The **Thamesmead Making Space for Nature** team has come up with 25 challenges for the summer holidays. How many can you tick off? Share your progress with us using the hashtag #SummerInThamesmead

☐ 1 Look under sticks and logs near trees – count how many different minibeasts you find.

☐ 2 Visit the heronry at **Tump 39**. There is a viewing platform off of **Templar Drive**.

☐ 3 Prepare a picnic and take it to your nearest park to eat.

☐ 4 Go on a walk and collect three things on your way that will remind you of your journey.

☐ 5 Find a quiet place to sit near some trees. Try to stay still for two minutes and count the number of birds that you see.

☐ 6 Visit the newly planted Trees in **Birchmere Park** – if it's a hot day share some of your water with them!

☐ 7 Visit **Claridge Way Woodland Walk** – can you see the brand new treehouse?

☐ 8 Visit **Claridge Way** – can you find the new gardening club?

☐ 9 Stand at the highest point of **Southmere Park** – count how many horses you can see.

☐ 10 Find the giant stones in **Southmere Park**. Make up a story for how they got there!

☐ 11 Count how many new wooden platforms there are on **Southmere Lake**.

☐ 12 Use sticks to make a house for a woodland creature – like a hedgehog, squirrel or fox.

☐ 13 Make a map of the place you live – add paths, roads, plants and trees.

☐ 14 Walk along the **Ridgeway** – what can you spot from this raised pathway?
- ☐ Can you spot **Southmere Lake**?
- ☐ Can you see any trees and plants with berries growing on them?
- ☐ Can you see horses in the fields?

☐ 15 Find a tree that needs a hug and stretch your arms around it.

☐ 16 Find an interesting building and sketch the outline.

☐ 17 Go for a walk in the rain! What's different about your local park when there's wet weather?

☐ 18 Find a place with lots of trees. Close your eyes and tell somebody what sounds you can hear.

☐ 19 Visit the **River Thames Footpath** and see if you can see any of Thamesmeads Seals!

☐ 20 Visit the Sunflower field in **Crossways Park**. Are the flowers still there? Can you find one the same height as you?

☐ 21 Look up at the clouds – choose one with an interesting shape and draw it before it disappears.

☐ 22 Use your hands to make a frame. Try framing:
- ☐ A scene with no people in it
- ☐ A scene that is full of tall trees
- ☐ A scene with some beautiful flowers growing
- ☐ A scene with children playing

☐ 23 Pretend you are a TV presenter filming a wildlife documentary in **Thamesmead**. Get someone to record you sharing something interesting in a park!

☐ 24 Visit **Birchmere Park** – how many swans are swimming on the lake today?

☐ 25 Discover and explore some of Thamesmead's hidden gems;
- ☐ **Crossways Canal**
- ☐ **Moat Garden**



# Explore Thamesmead's green spaces



We are spoilt for choice with so many nature spots on our doorstep. There's something nearby for everyone to safely explore outdoors during the holidays. Send us your photos of your favourites.
















As well as ticking off the challenges on the summer checklist, keep an eye on www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk for the latest news and follow #SummerInThamesmead on social media.

That is where you will find details about activities like the **Mini Family Ramble Challenge** (see also Page 7 of this newsletter) and **Thamesmead Market** (see Page 8).

They're designed to get everyone out and about and enjoying Thamesmead's many green spaces this summer. Plus there's things you can do at home on a rainy day too.

# Local support during Coronavirus

While we are constantly monitoring the situation, we are continuing to follow government guidance so have closed all community spaces, **The Link**, the **Information Hub** and our office on **Joyce Dawson Way**, for the time being.

If you'd like to talk to us about anything or have any questions please email us at thamesmeadnow@peabody.org.uk

If you have an urgent repair or housing issue we are still here to help in any way we can.

Please call our customer service centre on 0300 123 1237 if you need this sort of support.

## Bexley residents:

If you need support call the **Bexley Coronavirus helpline** – 020 3045 5398, between 8am to 6pm. If you would like to find out how different charities and voluntary groups can support your health and wellbeing, contact **Community Connect** - 0300 302 0041 (Mon-Fri, 9am-5pm)

## Greenwich residents:

If you live in **Greenwich** and are feeling anxious or lonely due to Covid-19, **Live Well Greenwich** has launched **Live Well Connect** – please call 0800 470 4831 for a listening ear and a friendly voice to talk to.

**Opening times:** Mon-Thurs 8.30am-7.30pm, Fri 8.30am-5.30pm, Sat 9am-12 noon (a message can be left outside of these hours).

## Thamesmead residents:

If you are a **Thamesmead** resident there are a number of local services which you can access.

**Positive Steps Thamesmead** can offer telephone advice and information on a range of issues including housing, benefits and immigration.

Please call **Positive Steps Thamesmead** on 07815 734080.




## COVID-19 National Testing Portal:

Anyone who has symptoms of **coronavirus** (**COVID-19**) can get a free test to check if they have the virus. You can get a test for yourself or for someone you live with if you/they have coronavirus symptoms (a high temperature, a new, continuous cough, or a loss or change to your sense of smell or taste). Some people without symptoms can have the test too.

You need to get the test done in the first 5 days of having symptoms. If you do not have symptoms, you can only get a test if your hospital has told you to.

Apply for the test as soon as you have symptoms. You can do it online. For more information go to www.nhs.uk and click on 'Find out about coronavirus'.

## Multi-Sports Activities:

Working with partners across **Royal Borough of Greenwich**, **Greenwich Leisure Limited** has organised various fun and socialising multi-sports activities to improve health and wellbeing throughout the summer holidays.

If you would like to join a multi-sports session this summer, please go to www.eventbrite.co.uk and search "GLL Sport"

## Social media

You may have noticed that we're sharing more of our day-to-day news and updates on our Twitter, Facebook and Instagram accounts.

If you'd like to stay up to date you can follow us on Twitter: @ThamesmeadLDN, on Facebook: @ThamesmeadNow and on Instagram @Thamesmeadnow

# Underpass overhaul complete

A new project has transformed **The Moorings** underpass from dark and seen as unsafe into a bright and stimulating space.

The need to rejuvenate the underpass was identified by the local community and Peabody as part of a drive to make the area safer and more welcoming for residents.



Before

Peabody commissioned and funded **The Granchester Pottery** and **Light Follows Behaviour** to produce a colourful tile mural and introduce new lighting. The mural was designed in collaboration with young people at **Woolwich Polytechnic** and **Hawksmoor Youth Club**.

It's a key part of the work Peabody is doing in **The Moorings**, with its wardens, environmental services, regeneration and culture teams all working together to create new amenities and tackle anti-social behaviour.

Other underpasses and bridges in Thamesmead are also set for a revamp thanks to a major new street art programme, details of which will be announced later this year.









## Volunteers needed!

We are looking for volunteers to assist behind the scenes on Peabody's **Remote Befriending** scheme.

The programme involves making follow-up calls to vulnerable and elderly tenants to check they would like to have a Befriender; taking short notes during calls.

There's no set time commitment but you will be asked to make a minimum of five calls. If you're interested, please email: volunteer@peabody.org.uk

# Hunt is on for days of fun

Take a break from lockdown boredom this summer and try the **Mini Family Ramble Challenge** starting from **Birchmere Hub** in Thamesmead.

Exercise body and mind by completing quiz questions and discover the images on the scavenger hunt to win one of the 20 Sports Activity packs provided by **Royal Borough of Greenwich** and **Greenwich Leisure Limited**.

To qualify for one of the activity sports packs you need to take a funny or creative picture of the members in your team or family group with one of the hunt images in the background. Then please email it to **Christine Carrasco** – christine.carrasco@peabody.org.uk

To download the quiz questions, scavenger hunt photos and map or find out more please go to www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk.

# Up market

This year's Festival may have been postponed but there's still an opportunity to celebrate everything that's great about Thamesmead.

The **Thamesmead Market** will take place on Sunday, 9 August from 12pm to 4pm on the north shore of **Southmere Lake**, next to the **Lakeside Centre**. It is being delivered with CC Events of Southmere Sundays fame, the Thamesmead Festival Production Group of 11 local residents and our partner, Serious.

The day will feature local food and craft traders, stalls from Bow Arts artists, so you can buy some of their work, and RTM will be broadcasting live.

To comply with strict Covid secure measures numbers will be managed, a one-way system will be in place and hand sanitisers will be available.

If government guidance changes we may be forced to cancel the event at short notice so please check www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk for the very latest information.




# Green light for eco youngsters

Local young people have taken part in Thamesmead's first ever **Youth Eco Development Council**. The ten youngsters, aged 15-18, have been meeting on Zoom every week to plan an environmentally aware social action project with funding from the National Lottery Heritage Fund, partnering with the London Wildlife Trust, London Youth, John Muir Trust and Headliners UK.

To start the project, the group took part in a Headliners UK training session to develop their social media skills. It has also built a relationship with Thames21 with a view to working together on a waterways project.

Follow the journey on their Instagram account @y_e_d_c

The young people will also receive a media skills accreditation and opportunities to apply for a London Wildlife Traineeship and contribute to the London Wildlife Trust's Youth Board. Anyone interested in taking part in should contact Nadia at nadia.kassab@peabody.org.uk

## Please visit thamesmeadnow.org.uk for updates

### Find out what's happening across Thamesmead

Sign up to the Thamesmead e-newsletter. Email us at thamesmeadnow@peabody.org.uk adding 'Sign me up' in the subject line.

### Social media

For the latest news and information – please stay in touch by following us

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